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1. Purpose and Scope

This document describes the HL7-protocol used in the BM850-instrument, and how the instrument is supposed to communicate with a Laboratory Information System using HL7.

2. References

[BASE64] <https://tools.ietf.org/html/rfc4648>
[HL7] <http://www.hl7.org>
[JSON] <http://json.org>

3. Changes from previous edition

- Updated 7.5.1 with VET parameters
- Updated 7.5.1 table with Market column
- Updated 7.5.2 with new parameter flags
- Updated example with new data

4. Terms and Definitions

ACK Acknowledgment
ER7 Encoding system defined in HL7
HL7 Health Level 7
JSON JavaScript Object Notation
LIS Laboratory Information System
MLLP Minimum Lower Layer Protocol, a protocol defined in HL7
TCP/IP Transmission Control Protocol/Internet Protocol

5. Introduction

The need for communication between a central information system and different medical devices is easily recognized. However, since there are a multitude of manufacturers of both medical devices and of information systems, there's a need of a standardized protocol used for the communication. HL7, [HL7], is standard for electronic data exchange in healthcare environments, which is becoming used more and more and customers are starting to ask for this protocol to be implemented in medical devices.

6. HL7 in BM850

Only sample results can be transmitted via HL7, and data is only sent in one direction (disregarding ACK:s), from the instrument to a LIS.

6.1. Version

The version of HL7 used by the BM850 instrument is 2.7.

6.2. Protocol

MLLP over TCP/IP is used as protocol.

6.3. Data-format

The data-format used is ER7, also known as "pipe-delimited".

7. Sample results

A sample message is composed of several different segments. An example message is shown in Appendix A.

Segment type	Segment name	Repetitions	Description
MSH	Message Header	1	Identifies the meaning of the message.
SFT	Software Segment	1	Information about the SW version in the instrument.
OBR	Observation Request	1	Identifies the sample.
NTE	Notes and Comments	1	User comment for the sample.
OBX	Observation Result	1-n	One segment for each item in the sample results

7.1. Message Header, MSH

Field	Name	Description
-------	------	-------------

1	Field separator	` `
2	Encoding Characters	`^~/&`
3	Sending Application	User configurable. Default is 'BM850^HL7MW'. Max 40 chars.
4-6		Empty
7	Date/Time of Message	Date/Time when the message was sent according to the instrument. 14 chars, YYYYMMDDHHMMSS.
8		Empty
9	Message Type	`ORU^R01`
10	Message Control ID	Set by the instrument to identify ACK. Max 20 chars.
11	Processing ID	`P`
12	Version ID	`2.7`
13-17		Empty
18	Character Set	`UNICODE UTF-8`

7.2. Software Segment, SFT

Field	Name	Description
1	Software Vendor Organization	`Boule Medical AB`
2	Software Certified Version or Release Number	Varies depending on the SW version. Max 50 chars.
3	Software Product Name	Varies depending on instrument model. Max 50 chars.
4	Software Binary ID	Repeat of field 2.

7.3. Observation Request, OBR

Field	Name	Description
1	Set ID	`1`
2		Empty
3	Filler Order Number	The sequence number of the sample as defined by the instrument. 1-99999.
4	Universal Service Identifier	Sample ID 1. Max 50 chars.
5-21		Empty
22	Result Report/Status Change Date/Time	Date and time when the sample was analyzed. 12 chars, YYYYMMDDHHMM.

7.4. Notes and Comments, NTE

Field	Name	Description
1	Set ID	`1`
2		Empty
3	Comment	User comment for the sample. Max 100 chars.

7.5. Observation Result, OBX

Field	Name	Description
1	Set ID	1- <i>n</i> , where <i>n</i> is the number of OBX-segments in the message.
2	Value Type	See chapter 7.5.1
3	Observation Identifier	See chapter 7.5.1
4		Empty
5	Observation Value	See chapter 7.5.1
6	Units	See chapter 7.5.1
7	Reference Range	See chapter 7.5.1
8	Interpretation Codes	See chapter 7.5.2
9-10		Empty
11	Observation Result Status	`P`

7.5.1. Data items in a sample results

The following table describes each item that can be sent in an OBX-segment. Only relevant items are sent, so if for instance the parameter *RBC* is not present in the sample results no OBX with Observation Identifier 'RBC' will be sent.

Note that the parameter names used in the table are the standard ones, and not the user-configured ones.

BM850	Observation Identifier	Observation Identifier	Value Type	Unit	Market (All,	Description
-------	------------------------	------------------------	------------	------	--------------	-------------

	Result	Alert Limit *			Human or Vet)	
RBC	RBC	RBCAL	NM	10*12/L	All	
MCV	MCV	MCVAL	NM	fL	All	
HCT	HCT	HCTAL	NM	%	All	
MCH	MCH	MCHAL	NM	pg	All	
MCHC	MCHC	MCHCAL	NM	g/dL	All	
RDW	RDWR	RDWRAL	NM	%	All	
RDW _a	RDWA	RDWAAL	NM	fL	All	
PLT	PLT	PLTAL	NM	10*9/L	All	
MPV	MPV	MPVAL	NM	fL	All	
PCT	PCT	PCTAL	NM	%	All	
PDW	PDW	PDWAL	NM	fL	All	
PDW%	PDWR	PDWRAL	NM	%	Human	Configurable in BM850 instrument
LPCR/P-LCR	LPCR or P-LCR	LPCRAL or P-LCRAL	NM	%	Human	Configurable in BM850 instrument
LPCA/P-LCC	LPCA or P-LCC	LPCAAL or P-LCCAL	NM	10*9/L	Human	Configurable in BM850 instrument
HGB	HGB	HGBAL	NM	g/dL	All	
WBC	WBC	WBCAL	NM	10*9/L	All	
LYM	LYMA	LYMAAL	NM	10*9/L	All	
MID	MIDA	MIDAAL	NM	10*9/L	Human	
MON	MONA	MONAAL	NM	10*9/L	Vet	
GRA	GRNA	GRNAAL	NM	10*9/L	All	When 3-part diff
NEU	NEUA	NEUAAL	NM	10*9/L	Vet	When 4-part diff
EOS	EOSA	EOSAAL	NM	10*9/L	Vet	When 4-part diff
LYM%	LYMR	LYMRAL	NM	%	All	
MID%	MIDR	MIDRAL	NM	%	Human	
MON%	MONR	MONRAL	NM	%	Vet	
GRA%	GRNR	GRNRAL	NM	%	All	When 3-part diff
NEU%	NEUR	NEURAL	NM	%	Vet	When 4-part diff
EOS%	EOSR	EOSRAL	NM	%	Vet	When 4-part diff
Sample ID 2	ID2	-	ST		All	Max 50 chars
Profile	PROF	-	ST		All	Max 50 chars
Method	METH	-	ST		All	See chapter 7.5.3
Operator	OPID	-	ST		All	Max 10 chars
Histogram	HGRAM	-	ED		All	See chapter 7.5.4

Table 1: Data items in sample OBX

* Alert Limits: Fields 2, 5 and 8 are empty. Only fields 6 and 7 contain any data.

7.5.2. Parameter flags

Possible values in field 8 in a sample OBX-segment. Only applicable for OBX-segments containing parameter values. Note that some of the flags below are only possible for specific markets.

Parameter Flag	Description
OR	Measuring chamber indicator, Measurement warning
DF	Reagent pipette indicator, Diluent system problem
DP	Reagent pipette indicator, Diluent system problem
LF	Reagent pipette indicator, Lyse system problem
LP	Reagent pipette indicator, Lyse system problem
TE	Mixing beaker indicator, Liquid system problem
TL	Reagent pipette indicator, Possible orifice blockage
TU	Reagent pipette indicator, Possible orifice blockage
ST	Reagent pipette indicator, Air bubbles
TB	Reagent pipette indicator, Air bubbles
HT	Temperature Indicator, Instrument temperature outside limits
HL	HGB indicator, HGB measuring problem

HH	HGB indicator, HGB measuring problem
HF	HGB indicator, HGB measuring problem
HO	HGB indicator, HGB measuring problem
HS	HGB indicator, HGB measuring problem
HN	HGB indicator, HGB measuring problem
ML	Out-of-Range Indicator, Parameter below measurement range
SE	Measuring chamber indicator, Measurement statistics warning
DE	Distribution indicator, Small particle interference
FD	Distribution indicator, Irregular distribution PLT/RBC. Re-analyze sample.
NM	WBC differential abnormality, No mode found for WBC
OM	WBC differential abnormality, Only one WBC population found
O2	WBC differential abnormality, Only one WBC population found
TM	WBC differential abnormality, More than two modes found in WBC distribution
BD	WBC differential abnormality, High interference between populations
RP	PLT-C profile indicator, Red cells present
AF	Aspiration indicator (sample probe), Aspiration failed
NR	Reagent and control indicator, Enter new reagent in Reagent setup menu
MB	PLT-C profile indicator, Missing background count
BL	Out-of-Range Indicator, Parameter below linear range
AL	Out-of-Range Indicator, Parameter above linear range
ER	Reagent and control indicator, Reagent is expired
EC	Reagent and control indicator, Control is expired
HW	HGB indicator, HGB measurement warning
EF	EOS reagent filling problem
EP	EOS reagent emptying problem
LW	Low WBC
LM	Lym mode. Only a LYM population found
MM	Mono Mode. Only a MON population found
GM	Gran Mode. Only a GRA population found
L2	Measurement warning. The sample may contain lyse resistant WBC
MH	Out-of-range indicator. Parameter above measurement range
SC	PLT indicator. Suspected PLT concentrate
XF	PLT indicator. Extended counting time failure

Table 2: Parameter flags

7.5.3. Method

Possible values for field 5 in a sample OBX-segment where the Observation Identifier is 'METH'. This is the aspiration method used when analyzing the sample.

Method	Description
OT	Open Tube
PD	Predilute
MC	Micro-capillary
CP	Cap Piercer
AS#xx	Auto Sample. xx is the position on the auto-sampler wheel.

Table 3: Aspiration methods

7.5.4. Histograms

Every sample results can contain a number of histograms. These histograms are formatted as a JSON-string [JSON], which is then encoded with Base64, [BASE64]. The encoded string is sent in the *Observation Value* field in the OBX-segment with identifier *HGRAM*.

The format of the JSON-string is as follows:

```
'<name>': {'count': <number_c>, 'min': <number_m>, 'max': <number_x>, 'filter':
<number_f>, 'disc': [<number_d>, ...], 'values': {'<name_1>': [<number_v>, ...],
<next_histg>}}
```

Tag	Value type	Description
<name>	String	Name of histogram

8.2. Message Acknowledgement, MSA

Field	Name	Description
1	Acknowledgement Code	See [HL7]
2	Message Control ID	Shall correspond to the value of field 10 in the MSH-segment in the message that is acknowledged.

8.3. Error Segment, ERR

Field	Name	Description
1-2		Empty
3	HL7 Error Code	See [HL7]. The minimum is that the code is specified, i.e. '200' for "Unsupported Message Type"
4	Severity	See [HL7]

Appendix A: Example HL7-message for sample results

[illegible]

wgMywgMiwgMSwgMSwgMSwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMCwgMF1
9fX0=|||||P<CR>
<EB><CR>

Where: <SB>=Start Block=0x0B, <CR>=Carriage Return=0x0D, <EB>=End Block=0x1c